

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

HENDERSON STATE UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL ROUTE

On-Site Review: November 6-7, 2024

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

HENDERSON STATE UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL ROUTE

Overall Performance Level		
MEETS		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
APPROACHING	MEETS	EXCEEDS

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

Standard 1 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	BELOW	APPROACHING
Recommendations		
Recruiting additional candidates, specifically in subject shortage areas, will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. Additionally, consider what additional supports those candidates may need to increase the 3-year completion rate. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2b, Criteria 1.3a)</i>		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	Henderson's Traditional Annual Plan is realistic given their past challenges and presents a path forward for success.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas’s workforce needs			
Metric	Target	EPP’s Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	-30.2%	BELOW

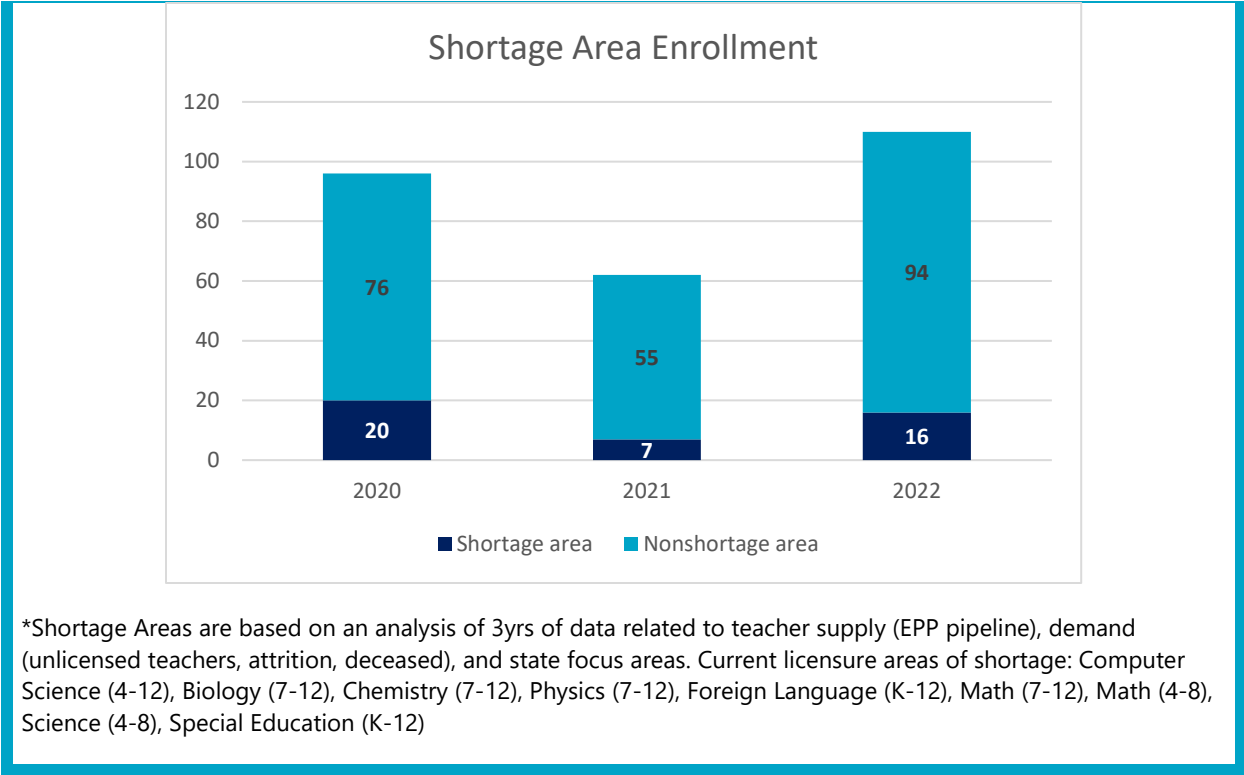
Enrollment

Metric is the percentage growth between the blue and green boxes.

Year	Enrollment
2017	66
2018	150
2019	168
2020	96
2021	62
2022	110

*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a “Meets” rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an “Exceeds” rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

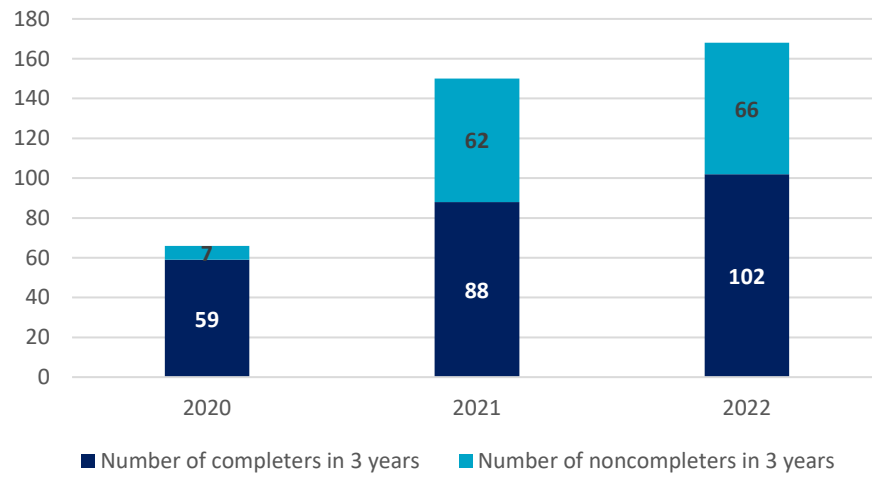
Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need			
Metric	Target	EPP’s Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	16%	APPROACHING



INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	74%	65%	APPROACHING

Completion



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
Henderson State University provided evidence to highlight its commitment to providing traditional teaching candidates with the knowledge, systems, and structures they need to teach in Arkansas schools, including a series of well-sequenced courses that provides candidates opportunities to build on their knowledge, and use skills in real-time in their classes. A highlight of the program is the multiple field experiences candidates have prior to entering their internship, providing them ample opportunities to experience various grade levels and students of varied learning needs. Course instructors and clinical supervisors demonstrated deep knowledge of content, strong facilitation and positive coaching to support all candidates in the program. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: - Audit coursework and clearly incorporate Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards ensuring candidates have adequate opportunities to develop knowledge and skills in their required licensure areas. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 2.1a Metric 2)</i> - By 2026-2027, EPPs will need to provide evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 2.2b, Metrics 1 and 2)</i> - Create collaborative processes and structures to fully support and develop clinical supervisors, that provide both faculty and non-faculty various opportunities to participate in training and professional development. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 2.2c Metric 2)</i>		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
MEETS
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction MEETS During the on-site review at Henderson State University, reviewers found that coursework incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction. Thirteen syllabi representing essential courses in each of the licensure areas for review were included in the evidence provided. These syllabi included core, methods, and progression point courses. The EPP noted that although several courses utilize HQIM, that was not explicitly stated in the syllabi. In Introduction to Teacher Education, one of the course objectives is: "The student will identify

various curriculum structures and instructional practices.” One of the objectives of the Math Methods course is: “Candidates will evaluate a designated HQIM and adapt it for a three-phase discovery lesson during internalization.”

In the Coursework focus group, teaching candidates described how they are required to utilize HQIM in planning lessons for their methods courses, including evaluating whether the HQIM is aligned with an Arkansas K-12 standard and modifying the materials as needed to ensure it does. All candidates agreed that there had been a clear progression from using HQIM in planning lessons during earlier classes to implementing it fully in later courses. Candidates have encountered some of the same HQIMs in field experiences they have worked with in their courses, including Eureka Math and Foundations. Candidates also described utilizing online resources like Newsela to supplement instruction when HQIM was unavailable for their content area or did not meet their students’ specific needs. In the Course Instructor focus group, participants shared that the EPP selected HQIM for their candidates based on an analysis of curriculum materials used by partnering school districts. The coursework guides candidates in evaluating HQIM using edReports generally (as well as for alignment to the Science of Reading specifically) and modifying HQIM as needed to ensure alignment with AR state standards. Candidates also use HQIM for lesson planning in their methods classes and complete an internalization protocol to prepare for teaching. In coursework observations, reviewers saw evidence of this as well. In Math Methods for Elementary and Middle Level (EDE4433/EDM4213), candidates evaluate HQIM and analyze selected curricula for alignment with AR Academic state standards. Henderson prepares teaching candidates in the Science of Reading awareness pathway through the internship integration of Arkansas IDEAS, which satisfies the state requirement.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally familiarizes candidates with the Arkansas Academic K-12 Standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area and provides candidates with opportunities to vertically integrate the Standards. Examples of lesson plans were included in the evidence showing the different stages of lesson planning and the incorporation of AR Academic K-12 State Standards in conjunction with other subject relevant standards such as reading standards for dyslexia, SHAPE PE standards, and ISTE technology standards. The three lesson plans submitted all include a section for what standard is being taught and document AR K-12 standards. In the Coursework focus group, teaching candidates provided evidence that almost all assignments require the utilization of K-12 standards. Candidates discussed that they had worked on assignments that required them to use standards across disciplines and grade levels. One candidate described being randomly assigned to grade levels during the completion of 120 field experience hours, to allow for opportunities to integrate standards into lesson plans across the full range of the licensure area.

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants shared that the lesson plan template includes a section for alignment to AR Academic K-12 standards. Candidates are introduced to K-12 Academic standards in the Teacher Education Orientation course to prepare for entrance interviews that require familiarity with standards aligned to their licensure area. In the Integrated Curriculum and Practicum (SPE 3051) course, candidates explore the progression of various standards across grade levels to plan lessons at multiple grades. Teacher candidates must also plan and deliver a three-lesson unit aligned to K-12 standards as part of their Impact on Student Learning Project (ISLP). In the coursework observation of EDE4433/EDM4213, reviewers observed candidates participating in lessons taught by other students from various grade bands.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses

MEETS

Courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced and increase in rigor throughout the program. Courses and program design include checkpoints for reinforcement opportunities. All candidates take Teacher Education Orientation (EDU 2000L) which is required for admission and includes the admissions interview. The second check is Orientation to Internship (EDU 4890), where the program verifies that candidates have the required GPA (2.7), required content coursework ("C" or better), all core coursework, 120 field experience hours, PRAXIS II Content, and satisfactory disposition checks from two faculty members before entering their internship semester. During the internship semester, candidates complete the third progression check, which includes effective ratings on their final university supervisor observation, acceptable ratings on the unit plan and Impact on Student Learning Project, passing scores on the Foundations of Reading exam (Elementary and Special Education candidates only), passing score on the PRAXIS Principles of Learning and Teaching, and satisfactory exit interview results.

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants confirmed this information. They described how courses progress, sharing the example of the progression from emergent literacy to developing literacy to writing in the content area to literacy methods. One course instructor said, "There is some flexibility in how candidates complete the foundational courses, but those introductory courses must be completed before moving on to the advanced methods courses. Rigor with lesson planning builds intentionally from planning basic lesson plans in the introductory course, to completing an entire unit in internship, to completing more advanced units in content-specific methods courses."

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework
APPROACHING

Coursework incorporates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in a way that partially develops candidates to meet the competencies of their licensure area. Evidence provided shows that while the Arkansas Teaching Standards are included in the handbook and syllabi, the AR Educator Competencies are not. The evidence shows that the EPP reviewed the matrix alignment from ADE and realized a lack of correlation to AR Educator Competencies within the syllabi. They have taken steps to remedy this and are reviewing courses to ensure the correct alignment. When considering the Arkansas Teaching Standards, the EPP submitted a crosswalk between the Danielson and TESS domains. Candidates are not explicitly using the Arkansas Teaching Standards, but rubrics are aligned where possible ensure candidate development. Of the 12 reviewed syllabi, 10 included specific references to InTASC standards and aligned them to the course objectives. The Teacher Education Program Dispositions are also cross walked to the Arkansas Teaching Standards. In the Course Instructor focus group, participants discussed the importance of modeling backward planning for candidates by utilizing the teaching standards the same way candidates are expected to use K-12 standards. Several instructors described utilizing an alignment matrix in their syllabi to guide coursework and sharing the teaching standards with candidates to provide clear expectations. The lesson plan template includes the 10 InTASC standards, and all lessons are linked to the corresponding standard.

In the Coursework focus group, candidates indicated that Coursework incorporates the Arkansas Teaching Standards through a crosswalk with the Danielson Framework so that candidates develop the knowledge and skills required by their licensure area. Candidates described how they are assessed on the Danielson Framework every few weeks in their classroom management course, including being asked to classify the domain where specific actions would be seen. Candidates also described a project in another course where they had to create a banner of the Danielson domains. In course observations, reviewers noted some evidence of Arkansas Educator competencies, although they were not explicitly stated. For example, in Special Methods: Health and Physical Education (HPE4603) candidates were preparing for the professional testing and assessments required for licensure, a component throughout the Educator Competencies.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

MEETS

Coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experience, and candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on the alignment with their clinical supervisor and course instructors. In the evidence submitted, HSU included artifacts demonstrating coursework and clinical alignment across field experience courses. Artifacts represent a progression of field experiences from "SPE 3013 Reflection Special Education Observations" which provides a reflection on classroom observations and "RDG 3130_Reflection on ISRIP_One Student" which reflects on the smaller impact on the student learning project in RDG 3130, where candidates tutor an emerging reader. "EDE 4433_Lesson and Reflection of Teach in Field" represents the lesson plan and reflection submitted during a methods course where students are expected to teach a lesson (self-created or given to them by the participating teacher) and contemplate their experience through to Internship "ISLP_Impact Project for Whole Group" during the internship semester where candidates create, teach and determine the impact of a unit of study. There are also multiple examples in the syllabi where observation hours and reflection writing are listed in the course objectives.

In the Coursework focus group, one participant shared that they observe classes across the K-12 spectrum to learn about essential topics such as engagement (think-pair-share) and special education scaffolding strategies when they are most relevant. Candidates have an opportunity to reflect on and articulate the alignment through writings incorporating field experience notes. In two of the three course observations, reviewers noted alignment in coursework and clinical experiences where teacher candidates reflected on their classroom observations with course instructors. One example of this was through weekly journal reflections completed in the online learning management system.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K-12 Academic State Standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. Of the 14 instructors on the roster, half have terminal degrees, most hold an AR teaching certificate and have PreK-12 teaching experience, most have been trained on the Aspiring Teacher rubric, and higher education teaching experience ranges from 2-30 years. In the Coursework focus group, candidates described their instructors as being credible because of their extensive previous experiences with K-12 education and as being passionate about their content. In the Course Instructor focus group, participants discussed their continued learning through LETRS and MathQuest training, professional organizations like NCTM and NCTE, and NBPTS certification. Three instructors attended the 2024 ADE Conference. In all three course observations, reviewers noted that instructor's showed deep knowledge of subject and pedagogy, stating that the instructor provided examples as she discussed content, made connections to prior learning and shared examples of how to teach the lesson to children.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

APPROACHING

Some course instructors show evidence of strong facilitation of coursework and providing feedback and support. The EPP provided evidence of feedback including samples from interviews and coursework. The "TRAD Feedback_EdPsych" document provides several examples of instructor feedback on various assignments to

candidates in various programs. "TRAD Feedback_ISLP" includes examples of feedback on the major project during internship. The final two documents, "TRAD Feedback_Entrance" and "TRAD Feedback_Exit", show feedback provided to candidates during interviews that occur as part of their entrance and exit from the program.

Teacher candidates in the Coursework focus group provided examples of feedback and strong instruction, describing instructors as engaging and accurate with their feedback. One candidate described how their math assessment instructor provides extensive feedback specific to their strength and areas for growth. Another candidate described how their instructor provides feedback in the moment while they are delivering lessons or leading activities in class. All participants agreed that their instructors provide candidates with their contact information, and candidates discuss utilizing text messages and office hours for ongoing support. Most instructors also allow candidates to turn in assignments early for feedback that can then be used for revisions before the deadline. However, in two of the three course observations, reviewers did not see evidence of strong instruction or feedback. For example, in one online observation the reviewers noted teacher candidates responded to each other's posts in a discussion board, but there was no evidence that the instructor was engaged. In another recorded observation, the course instructor read directly from a textbook for nearly the full class, and while she did demonstrate the various phonological sounds, she did not pause for questions or engagement.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. As a requirement of the coursework, teacher candidates are required to complete various field experiences. For example, some courses such as Lit and Language Arts in the Elementary Classroom (EDE 4283) and Language Arts Practicum for Middle Grades (EDM 4233), teacher candidates are required to complete 30 hours of field experience. In the "Trad Candidate Experiences in Field" documentation, teacher candidates indicated which classroom activities they participated in as part of their field experience. In addition to observing, nearly half of respondents supported in the classroom with tasks such as handing out paperwork, grading, tutoring, and working with students in different capacities.

During their internship semester, teacher candidates teach with full-time responsibilities. In the Clinical Experience focus group and in the Clinical Supervisor focus group, all participants agreed they felt teacher candidates were prepared because of their earlier field experiences, and all candidates agreed that their experiences had increased in rigor.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students of varied learning needs. HSU partners with over 30 school districts and the "Teacher Education Program Handbook" details guidelines for internship placements of the Professional Internship Semester. No less than 40% of the total assignment should be completed in a particular grade range. Over the course of the program, teacher candidates engage in multiple field experiences through their coursework requirements, exposing them to a variety of classroom settings and students. During their internship, teacher candidates are required to intern in two different

classrooms so they can experience different grade levels, organically exposing them to a variety of students. In the Clinical Experience focus group, candidates stated that in their clinical experiences they had the opportunity to work with students on IEPs, 504 plans and behavior plans. One participant gave the example of pulling small groups of students and working with them individually. The other participants agreed that this was also their experience. While teacher candidates agree that they work with a variety of learners, candidates who are not working towards licensure in special education stated they would like more Special Education training to help them wherever they are placed.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Most experienced mentor teachers (cooperating teachers) demonstrate they have the coaching skills to properly support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development. In the evidence provided, survey results were included that showed 93% of teacher interns would recommend their experienced mentor teacher. On a four-point scale, interns rated mentor teachers an average of 3.7 for offering constructive criticism on preparation and planning, classroom environment, teaching, and professionalism. The "Samples of Feedback from Cooperating Teacher to Intern Aligned to ATR" sheet was submitted as evidence. Experienced mentor teachers track their feedback, evidence, goals, priorities, and possible strategies for growth for each intern in a document shared with the EPP. In the Clinical Experience focus group, eleven out of eleven teacher candidates shared examples of their experienced mentor teacher providing support and confidence in the candidate. Most candidates cited their feedback as an effective lever in their development. In the Experienced Mentor Teacher focus group, participants said that they did not attend a training led by HSU, however on the Experienced Mentor Teacher roster, all 54 mentor teachers received an effectiveness rating of "effective" or "highly effective," and about 80% are trained on TESS or Aspiring Teacher rubric. Currently, about 40% have completed a state recognized coaching training.

Note: By 2026-2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

APPROACHING

A partial process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers based on a set of criteria. While HSU lists criteria in the "Internship Handbook and Syllabus" for experienced mentor teachers, it is not clear if these criteria are always met. In the Partnership focus group, the seven school leaders listed several criteria for selecting their experienced mentor teachers, such as years of classroom experience, demonstrated instructional effectiveness, depth of content, and pedagogical knowledge. However, their selection processes are informal, and not all school leaders follow the required DESE criteria or criteria outlined in the HSU Handbook. From the focus group, reviewers concluded that districts use individual criteria based on administration preference. There was no evidence provided that the EPP is involved or provides criteria for mentor selection. All selections seem to come from the district.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors

MEETS

Most program clinical supervisors have a proven history and show evidence of effective instructional practices. In the documents provided, the "Henderson State -- University Supervisor List" spreadsheet provides the credentials for Fall 2024 clinical supervisors (university supervisors). The "University Supervisor Evaluations by Interns sheet" shows the evaluations by interns for the Fall 2023 and Spring 2024 university supervisors. Additionally, the

"University Supervisor Evaluations by Cooperating Teacher sheet" shows the evaluations by cooperating teachers for the Fall 2023 and Spring 2024 university supervisors. Averages are in the range of 98% of university supervisors receiving a "YES" for future use by interns and a 98% "YES" recommendation for future use by cooperating teachers.

Teacher candidates said their clinical supervisor offered constructive criticism on preparation and planning, classroom environment, teaching, and professionalism. In three out of three clinical experience observations with coaching post conferences, review teams found that the coaching provided by clinical supervisors was strong and effective. Each time there was a discussion with the intern about what went well, what didn't work, and what they would improve for the next lesson. The clinical supervisors gave specific feedback and instructional strategies to improve in areas such as writing objectives for the students, transitions and partner choices.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates

MEETS

Candidates consistently receive high quality feedback. In the documents provided, the "Samples of Feedback from University Supervisor (US) to Intern Aligned to ATR" sheet provides identified goals and written feedback to current (Fall 2024) interns by the clinical supervisor (university supervisor). Overarching feedback and domain-specific goals and feedback are included. There is also the opportunity to provide evidence of progress in prior areas for growth. Interns receive four formal observations from their clinical supervisor and are informally observed by their mentor teacher throughout the internship. Observation rubrics used by clinical supervisors and mentor teachers are aligned with the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, one participant shared clinical supervisors and mentor teachers "probably give too much feedback!" Feedback is provided on lesson plans, after observations and on other items as requested, and throughout the coursework. In the Clinical Experience focus group, ten out of eleven participants shared that feedback is shared orally in debriefs and written in the TK20 platform. Participants in the music department shared that although they felt they receive the support needed to be successful, they do not receive written feedback regularly. In coaching observations, all reviewers saw evidence of feedback tied to specific Danielson domains and built on previous feedback. One supervisor frequently emphasized aligning assessment measures to learning goals to ensure student learning is measured effectively.

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024-25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place with most schools to co-construct the clinical internship. Henderson has cultivated strong relationships with partner schools as part of the Partners in Education (PIE) committee. These school partners meet twice per year with HSU to discuss their partnership. In the Partnership focus group, all participants agreed they have a very positive relationship with HSU and gave multiple examples of how they work with HSU to co-construct the internship experience. One example is of a school district that recently implemented a non-traditional calendar. They worked with HSU to ensure teacher candidates would be able to meet the minimum number of required hours for their degree program by utilizing them in different capacities during the "off weeks." Another example was provided when a partner school was no longer authorized to take Special Education candidates due to state policy changes regarding inclusion. They notified HSU and worked together to identify other partners to step in and support the candidates. All seven participants in the School Partnership focus

group agreed that they can communicate with HSU staff about any issue, and that they would be able to work together to solve it very quickly.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes are consistently in place to support and develop effective clinical supervisors. At the beginning of each semester, clinical supervisors (university supervisors) participate in a training that reviews their role and expectations. It focuses on the expectations of the clinical experience and how clinical supervisor should support their interns, how to report internship concerns, and a discussion of each rubric, its different criteria and descriptors. They are also invited to the four "Hot Topic" sessions that include topics such as career fairs and professional development. Reviewers noted from the focus group that faculty-based clinical supervisors have a different experience and participate in significantly more training than non-faculty supervisors, including district and co-op professional development and state conferences or training. However, after reviewing all evidence, reviewers found that all clinical supervisors are adequately supported in their role.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

Most candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. GPA data shows that 93% of teacher candidates maintained a 3.0 GPA or above from admission into the program through internship and 60% of candidates improved their GPA throughout the program.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates are provided with support if their coursework requirements are not on track. Beginning in Spring 2024, the university began using Degree Works which allows both advisors and teacher candidates to view their degree progress. When candidates meet with their advisors each semester to schedule courses, they also review degree progress to ensure they are on track. If they are not on track, the advisor works individually with a candidate to get them back on track. The documentation suggests that HSU utilizes an early alert system that notifies the advisor and the program director if a candidate is off-track. Instructors provide their contact information and are available to provide support as needed, as well as intentionally checking in with students at the beginning of each class about their progress on the coursework and Praxis testing. In the Course Instructor focus group, a participant gave an example that the math methods classes provide candidates with tutors who have previously been in the course, and other instructors discussed the impact of students helping each other in their courses. While there was no evidence of a formal process to document support, all candidates feel supported, and it is evident they receive support when needed.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

Programs have a clear set of goals and milestones, and most candidates meet them. The “Application Data” shows that all teacher candidates passed their Praxis exam and met the requirements to begin their internship semester. The “Impact on Student Learning Project” (ISLP) data shows that most candidates earn a “3” out of “4” or above. If they didn’t earn the minimum passing score, they can work with their clinical supervisor to improve their rating. In the Clinical Experience focus group, candidates shared that they set goals with their supervisor and measured their progress after each observation.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

There is adequate evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. In the documentation provided there is evidence that all undergraduate teacher candidates complete the “Impact on Student Learning Project” (ISLP) at the end of the program. The ISLP requires teacher candidates to submit student pre- and post-assessments and reflect on their own lesson plan and student growth data. Teacher candidates present their project and findings as part of their exit interview to graduate from the program.

In the Clinical Experience focus group, one candidate shared examples of analyzing student data through exit tickets, and another talked about how they measured their students’ mastery of a skill so they could move to the next lesson. In one of the course observations, reviewers noted that the supervisor referenced the pre and post assessment plan and frequently emphasized aligning assessment measures to learning goals to ensure student learning is measured effectively.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

In the documentation provided it is evident that most candidates receive a score of effective or highly effective on their formal observations. During the 2024-25 semesters, HSU used the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. One hundred percent of teacher candidates in the Fall 2023 and Spring 2024 cohorts scored at least an “effective” rating in their observations. The overall average observation rating improved from the first observation to the second observation in all domains.

Note: By 2024-25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

MEETS

Most candidates with varied needs are provided with effective support, including individualized support plans. Clinical supervisors meet with their teacher candidates once per month, and teacher candidates are on campus at least once monthly for Hot Topic days. There are consistent check-ins in place to identify candidates struggling with their internship. All eleven participants in the Clinical Experience focus group. In the Clinical Experience focus group, participants agreed they receive the support they need. One participant shared, “My clinical supervisor has been supportive since day one. I’ve sat in their office and cried. We have the freedom to express concerns without putdown.”

High performing candidates receive opportunities and feedback that encourage retention. Program staff shared that at the end of each semester, interns are recommended by their cooperating teachers, clinical supervisors, and faculty for varying awards, including Outstanding Overall Intern, outstanding intern by content area, and the Ryan Halaby Award (intern that has overcome significant challenges to reach internship). These awards recognize candidates for their performance and progress during the internship semester. In addition to these rewards,

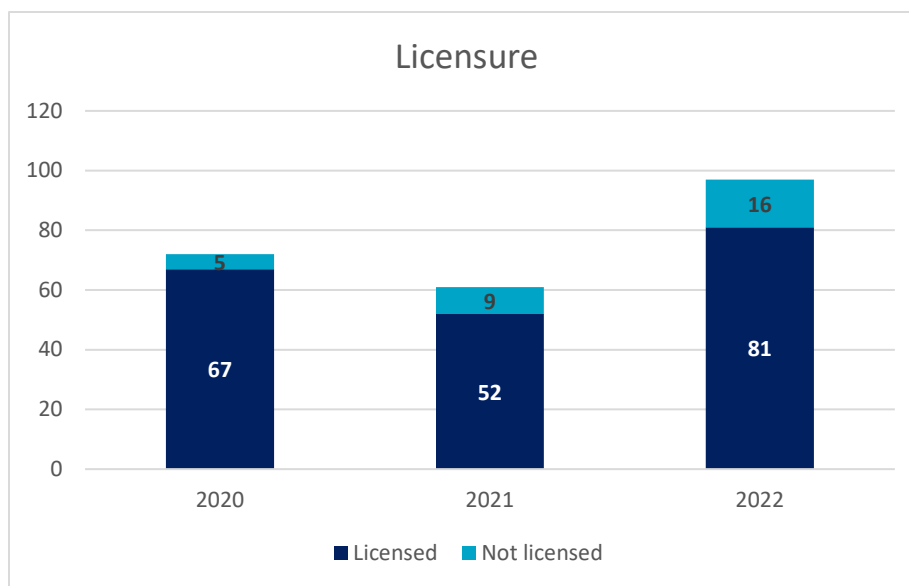
teacher candidates also shared that their clinical supervisors work with them on job applications and preparing for interviews, and many will receive job offers during or at the end of their internship semester.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
EXCEEDS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
EXCEEDS	EXCEEDS	MEETS
Recommendations		
Seventy three percent of Henderson State's program completers go on to obtain a standard license after passing their content area exam on their first try, with 87% of candidates earning licensure within one year of completion. Seventy six percent of completers who are licensed, gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion. Recommendations include: Analyze EPP Completer Supervisor Survey and EPP Completer Survey results to identify specific domains and components for which both supervisors and candidates do not feel their program prepared them well to become a teacher. (Focus Areas: Criteria 3.3a and 3.3b)		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license within one year of completion	76%	87%	EXCEEDS

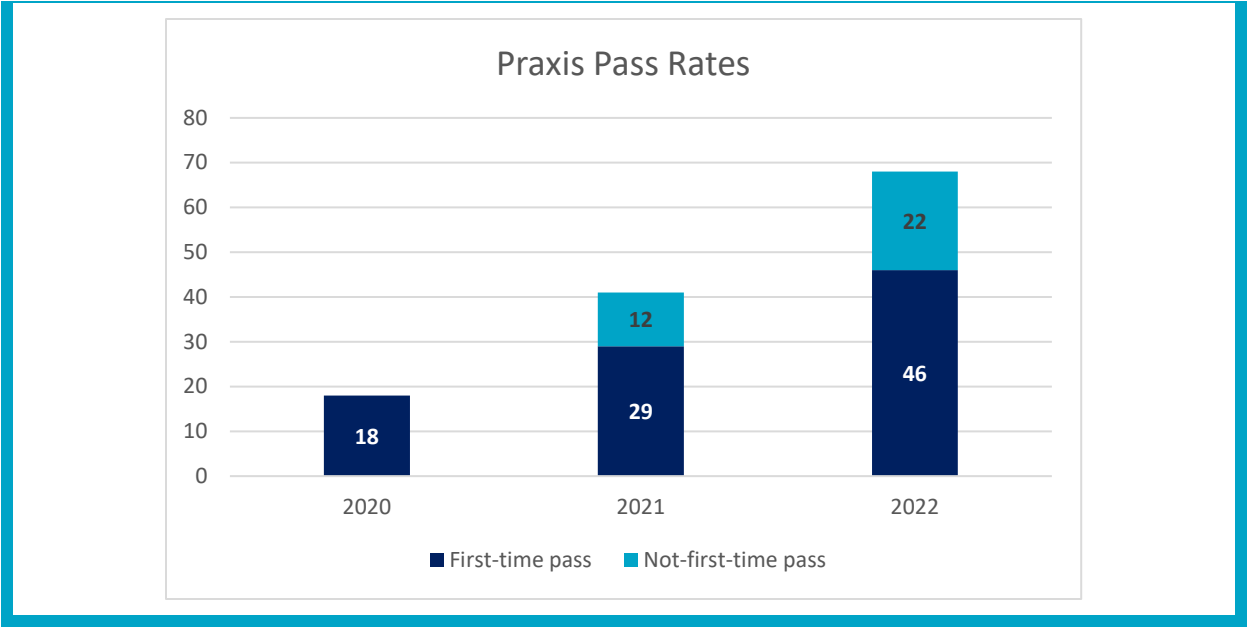


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	69%	n/a	n/a

Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	65%	73.2%	EXCEEDS



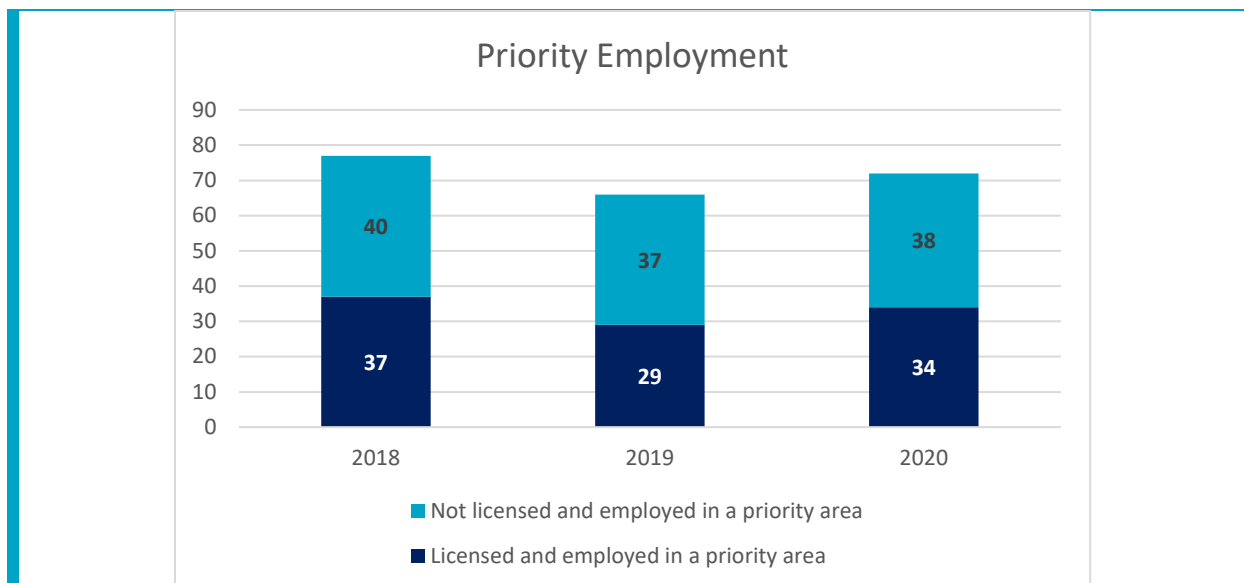
INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	64%	76.3%	EXCEEDS

Employment

Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed
2018	50	27
2019	57	9
2020	57	15

Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	40%	46.5%	EXCEEDS



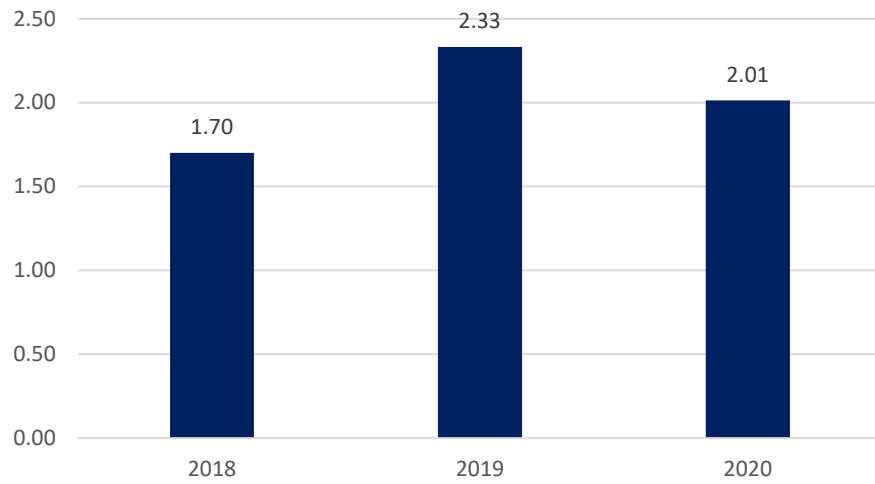
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

Current subject shortage areas for employment: Computer Science, Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.7	2	EXCEEDS

Average experience 3 years after completion



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	81%	76.3%	MEETS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	75%	71.2%	MEETS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	52%	EXCEEDS

